

MUMBAI PORT AUTHORITY
Planning Department

Building Permission Portal
Product Requirements Document (PRD)

A Conceptual & Product-Level Specification — No Technical Implementation Detail

Field	Detail
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1. Document Purpose & How to Read This PRD

This document exists for one reason: to give a reader who has never seen this project before — particularly a third-party developer, vendor, or new team member — a complete and accurate mental picture of what the Building Permission Portal is, why it exists, who it serves, and how it is meant to behave, before any technical conversation begins.

This is deliberately a conceptual and product-level document. It does not describe code, databases, platforms, APIs, file structures, or implementation choices. Anyone reading this document should be able to close it and correctly answer the questions “what does this system do?”, “who is it for?”, “why does each feature exist?”, and “what does success look like?” — without needing to know a single line of how it is built.

A separate technical document (covering platform, data model, and implementation specifics) is expected to follow this PRD once the reader has internalised the product itself. That document is out of scope here by design.

1.1 Intended Audience

- A developer or vendor being onboarded to build, extend, or maintain the system.
- A new MbPA Planning Department team member who needs full context quickly.
- Any reviewer, auditor, or approving authority who needs to understand the product's intent without technical noise.

1.2 What “No Technical Detail” Means Here

Wherever this document describes a capability — for example, automatic fee calculation, or officer review — it describes what happens and why it matters, not how it is computed or stored. Numbers and regulatory rules that are policy facts (e.g., a premium percentage prescribed by UPDR-2026) are included because they are part of the product's purpose, not because they are technical specifications.

2. Executive Summary

The Building Permission Portal is a digital system that takes a building permission all the way through its real statutory lifecycle — from first application to final Occupancy Certificate — within Mumbai Port Authority's planning jurisdiction. An applicant applies once, receives an automatic preliminary compliance and fee picture, is guided through each of up to seven regulatory milestones as construction progresses, is reviewed at each milestone by the correct MbPA officer(s), pays the correct charge at the correct point in the lifecycle, and receives a digital certificate at every milestone that is cleared — without needing to visit an office or interpret regulation manually.

It replaces what was previously a manual, paper-based, in-person process with a transparent, trackable, and consistent digital one. Every applicant sees the same rules applied the same way, every time, because the system itself enforces the regulation (drawn exclusively from the UPDR-2026 framework) rather than leaving interpretation to whichever officer happens to be reviewing the file.

The system serves two distinct audiences on a single platform: applicants (architects, builders, property owners) on one side, and four MbPA officer roles — Estate Officer, Junior Planner, Deputy Planner, and Chairman — on the other, each responsible for specific milestones in the lifecycle rather than all reviewing every application identically. Both interact

with the same underlying application record, but through very different views suited to their role.

A built-in accountability mechanism continuously tracks how long each milestone has been sitting with an officer. If an officer does not act within the statutory time allowed, the system automatically escalates the file and flags the delay against that officer — ensuring the applicant is never permanently stuck waiting on an unresponsive official.

In short: it is MbPA's digital front door and internal workflow engine for the entire building permission lifecycle — the Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) flagship deliverable for the Planning Department.

3. Background & Strategic Context

3.1 Why Mumbai Port Authority Has Its Own Building Permission Process

Mumbai Port Authority is not an ordinary landowner subject to the city's regular municipal planning process. Under the Major Port Authorities Act, 2021, MbPA holds the status of a Special Planning Authority (SPA) for land under its control. This means MbPA itself — not the Municipal Corporation of Greater Mumbai (MCGM/BMC) — is the authority that grants building permissions on its land, following its own regulatory document.

That regulatory document is UPDR-2026 (Unified Port Development Regulations, 2026) — MbPA's own equivalent of a city's Development Control Regulations. It is the single source of truth for every rule the portal enforces: what is permitted, what counts as a deficiency, and what premium must be paid to regularise a deficiency.

3.2 The Problem Being Solved

Before this portal, the building permission process at MbPA followed the conventional manual model common to many planning authorities:

- Applications were submitted as physical paper files.
- Compliance checking against regulation (FSI, open space, parking, etc.) was done manually by an officer, which is slow and prone to human inconsistency.
- Fee and premium calculations were computed manually, with the associated risk of arithmetic or interpretive error.
- Files physically moved between officers for multi-stage review, with no easy way for an applicant to know where their file currently was.
- There was no single, reliable trail of who reviewed what, when, and why — making audits and accountability harder.
- Applicants had to visit the office in person to check status or respond to queries.

This created delay, unpredictability, and a poor experience for anyone trying to get a legitimate construction project approved — directly working against the government's broader Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) agenda, which MbPA's Planning Department has been mandated to support.

3.3 The Strategic Response

The Building Permission Portal is MbPA Planning Department's direct response to this problem: a single digital system where the applicant submits once, the system itself applies UPDR-2026 rules consistently and instantly, officers review digitally instead of on paper, and

the entire history of the application — every check, every flag, every approval — is preserved automatically.

4. Vision Statement

“Applying for a building permission within Mumbai Port Authority's jurisdiction should feel as transparent and predictable as tracking a courier shipment — at every moment, the applicant should know exactly where their file stands, what is expected of them, and what it will cost.”

This vision drives every feature decision in the product: if a feature does not make the process faster, more transparent, more consistent, or more accountable than the old paper process, it does not belong in the portal.

5. Goals & Objectives

5.1 Primary Goals

- **Reduce approval turnaround time** — by removing physical file movement and manual calculation delays.
- **Guarantee regulatory consistency** — every applicant's project is checked against the exact same UPDR-2026 rules, with no officer-to-officer variation.
- **Create a transparent, self-service status view** — applicants should never need to visit or call the office just to ask “where is my file?”
- **Eliminate manual fee/premium calculation errors** — the system computes deficiency-based premiums automatically and consistently.
- **Build a permanent, reviewable audit trail** — every officer decision (verify/flag/remark) is preserved against the application record.
- **Support MbPA's Ease of Doing Business (EoDB) mandate** — this portal is a flagship EoDB deliverable for the Planning Department, and is judged against that standard.
- **Digitally issue a trustworthy final certificate** — a digitally generated, consistently formatted approval document, replacing manually drafted letters.

5.2 Secondary Goals

- Reduce in-person office visits and physical paperwork for both applicants and officers.
- Provide a foundation that can later support the full statutory multi-level sign-off chain, beyond the simplified version currently in place.
- Reflect MbPA's institutional identity (visual branding, terminology) rather than appearing as a generic municipal-style form system.

6. Non-Goals (Explicitly Out of Scope)

To avoid scope confusion for anyone picking up this project, the following are explicitly NOT what this portal is meant to be:

- It is not a GIS / mapping platform. It does not visualise plots on a map or manage spatial layers; it manages the application workflow and document outputs for a specific plot/project.
- It is not a substitute for physical site inspection. Officer adjudication in the portal is a desk/documentary review of submitted parameters and uploaded documents, not a replacement for any on-site verification MbPA's process otherwise requires.
- It does not apply to land outside MbPA's SPA jurisdiction. Regular municipal (MCGM/BMC) building permissions are entirely out of scope — even though some of the portal's form structure may resemble familiar municipal formats, the legal authority and rules behind it are exclusively MbPA's own (UPDR-2026).
- It is not a general-purpose document management system for the Planning Department. Its scope is the building permission application lifecycle specifically.
- It is not a live payment gateway. The portal records the challan/transaction reference number for a payment made outside the system (and an optional self-uploaded receipt) — it does not process card or bank payments itself, nor does it independently verify with a bank that money was actually received.
- It does not maintain its own database of official government land valuation rates (the Zonal Ready Reckoner Rate). Whoever is filing or estimating fees must look up and enter the correct, current rate for that zone from MbPA's actual Ready Reckoner — the portal deliberately never invents or pre-fills this figure.

7. Target Users & Personas

The portal exists for two fundamentally different audiences sharing one system: people trying to get a building permission carried through its full lifecycle, and the four MbPA officer roles who must evaluate and clear it at different points in that lifecycle. Understanding both sides is essential to understanding the product.

Importantly, the officer roles below are not all involved in every application in the same way. Each of the seven lifecycle milestones (Section 9) is assigned to one or more specific roles — for example, the very first milestone is jointly cleared by the Estate Officer and then the Junior Planner, while the final milestone is cleared solely by the Chairman. An officer only ever sees the applications currently sitting at a milestone their role is responsible for.

7.1 The Applicant (Architect / Builder / Property Owner)

Who they are: Typically a licensed architect filing on behalf of a property owner, or occasionally the owner/builder directly. Technically competent in construction and drawings, but not necessarily expert in MbPA-specific regulatory terminology.

Their goal: Get a building project carried through every required regulatory milestone — from initial approval to final Occupancy Certificate — as quickly and predictably as possible, with full clarity on cost at each step before committing.

Current frustration (pre-portal): No visibility into where a paper file is in the review chain; uncertainty about what triggers a deficiency/concession or extra cost until told, sometimes very late, by an officer; repeated office visits to check status; no clear way to flag an unresponsive officer.

What success looks like for them: They can register and apply entirely online, immediately see which parameters of their project are compliant versus requiring a concession (and what each will cost), track progress through every lifecycle milestone without visiting the office, raise a complaint if an officer is unresponsive, and download a certificate the moment each milestone is approved.

How they use the portal: Registers once with verified identity details, logs in, creates a new application by selecting the appropriate permission type and completing a guided intake form, reviews the automatic compliance/fee picture, submits, and then returns — either via a full account login or the lighter-weight 'Know your status' check — to track progress, file the next milestone's documents, or raise a complaint, until the full lifecycle is complete.

7.2 Estate Officer — First Touchpoint for New Filings

Who they are: An MbPA officer responsible for the very first check on a newly filed application or, for re-erection projects, for certifying that a site has been properly demolished and cleared before any new construction can begin.

Their goal: Confirm at the earliest possible point that the applicant's basic standing on the land (lease/allotment, site particulars) is in order, before deeper technical scrutiny begins.

Current frustration (pre-portal): No structured first-line gatekeeping step existed in the old process to catch basic land-standing issues before they consumed a technical officer's time.

What success looks like for them: Can clear or flag the most fundamental land-related checks quickly, so that only properly-founded applications proceed to detailed technical review.

How they use the portal: Opens applications waiting at this very first checkpoint (or, for demolition/re-erection cases, waiting for site-clearance certification), reviews the relevant submission, and either clears it forward to the next officer in that milestone or returns it for correction.

7.3 Junior Planner (JP) — Technical Scrutiny Officer

Who they are: An MbPA Planning Department officer responsible for technical scrutiny at specific milestones — notably immediately after the Estate Officer's first check, and again at the 80%-built-up-area construction milestone.

Their goal: Quickly and accurately verify each parameter of an application against UPDR-2026 at the milestones assigned to this role, flagging anything that needs the applicant's attention or correction.

Current frustration (pre-portal): Manually cross-checking each parameter against the regulation book for every single application, with no structured way to record exactly what was checked or why something was flagged.

What success looks like for them: A clear review screen where each item can be marked compliant or flagged with a reason in a few clicks, with nothing falling through the cracks.

How they use the portal: Opens their review queue, goes through each pending application's parameters and uploaded documents in a structured review screen, marks the file as cleared or returns specific documents for correction with a reason, and the file moves on.

7.4 Deputy Planner (DP) — Senior Technical Officer

Who they are: A more senior planning officer responsible for the largest share of milestone clearances — design sanction/foundation clearance, sub-structure validation, the remaining-20%-BUA construction milestone, and final service-infrastructure/completion review.

Their goal: Carry out thorough technical review at each of these milestones, with full visibility of everything submitted and any prior officer's findings on the same file.

Current frustration (pre-portal): No structured way, in the old process, to see exactly what an earlier reviewer (on an earlier milestone) had already checked — each review tended to start from scratch.

What success looks like for them: Can see the application's full history across every prior milestone, clear or return the current one with one click, and trust that the record speaks for itself.

How they use the portal: Reviews applications waiting at whichever of their assigned milestones is current, clears them forward (advancing the lifecycle, and where relevant collecting the milestone's required payment reference) or returns specific documents for correction.

7.5 Chairman — Final Approving Authority

Who they are: The senior-most authority whose sign-off finalises the building permission lifecycle under MbPA's SPA powers — responsible specifically for the final milestone (Occupancy Certificate).

Their goal: Make a fully-informed final approval decision quickly, with complete confidence that the application has already passed every earlier statutory milestone properly.

Current frustration (pre-portal): Final sign-off historically required a fully manually-prepared file with no guarantee of consistent prior scrutiny quality across the whole lifecycle.

What success looks like for them: Receives only applications that have already cleared all six earlier milestones, and approving instantly triggers the Occupancy Certificate and a complete final dossier — no manual drafting needed.

How they use the portal: Reviews the fully-vetted application at the final milestone and approves it, which automatically issues the Occupancy Certificate and compiles the complete document dossier for the applicant.

7.6 System Deployer / Internal Administrator

Who they are: Not a public-facing role — someone on the MbPA/technical side responsible for setting up officer accounts and basic configuration when the system is deployed or updated.

Their goal: Ensure the right people are registered against the right officer roles, and that core configuration (permission types, fee coefficients, etc.) reflects current UPDR-2026 rules.

Current frustration (pre-portal): N/A — this is a new role created by the portal itself.

What success looks like for them: Officer roles and core settings are set up correctly once, and rarely need to be touched again except when regulations or staff change.

How they use the portal: Performs one-time or occasional setup tasks (registering officer accounts against roles, confirming configuration values) rather than day-to-day application processing.

8. Key Concepts — The Product's Mental Model

Before describing features, it helps to understand the small set of core concepts the entire product is built around. Almost every feature in this PRD is a way of creating, checking, moving, paying for, or certifying one of these things.

Concept	What It Means in This Product
Application	A single building permission request for one project/plot, from first submission through to final Occupancy Certificate (or earlier rejection/correction). Everything else in the system attaches to an Application.
Application Number	A unique, human-readable reference automatically assigned to every Application the moment it is created (e.g. MBPASPA2026061), used by everyone — applicant and officers — to refer to that file unambiguously.
Stream	The category of permission being sought — e.g. a brand-new building, an addition/alteration to an existing one, a temporary permission, or regularisation of unauthorised construction. The Stream an applicant selects determines which lifecycle Milestones apply, how many there are, and which special rules govern the project (see Section 9.2).
Milestone	One statutory stage of the building-permission lifecycle (e.g. Approval in Principle, Development Permission, Occupancy Certificate). A Stream is made up of a specific sequence of Milestones. Each Milestone has its own required documents, its own responsible officer(s), and its own regulatory output document.
Concession	A specific way in which a project departs from the standard regulatory entitlement and therefore requires extra justification and a Premium payment to be permitted — e.g. seeking additional floor space beyond standard entitlement, providing less open space than required, or seeking a parking waiver.
Premium	The additional charge prescribed by UPDR-2026, payable to formally permit a specific Concession. Calculated from the extra area involved, the official land rate for that zone, and a fixed regulatory coefficient (see Section 11.2).
Master Challan	The single combined payment due at the Development Permission milestone, bundling the scrutiny fee, refundable security deposit, refundable debris-disposal deposit, and any Premium owed — settled before technical scrutiny of that milestone begins.
Zonal RRR (Ready Reckoner Rate)	The official government land valuation rate for a given port zone, used to calculate Premiums. The portal never invents or pre-fills this figure — it must be looked up from MbPA's actual Ready Reckoner and entered by whoever is filing or estimating.
Document Slot	A specific document or certificate that UPDR-2026 requires for a given Milestone (e.g. a structural stability certificate, a fire-safety NOC, a plinth-completion intimation). Each Milestone has its own fixed checklist of Document Slots.

Concept	What It Means in This Product
Scrutiny / Review	The structured process where an MbPA officer examines an Application's submitted details and documents at its current Milestone and records a decision — clear it forward, or return specific documents for correction with a reason.
Approval Chain	The role, or short sequence of roles, responsible for clearing a given Milestone — e.g. Estate Officer then Junior Planner for the first milestone; the Deputy Planner alone for several others; the Chairman alone for the final one.
SLA / Deemed Clearance	Every Milestone carries a prescribed number of working days for the responsible officer to act. If that time lapses without action, the system automatically advances the Application to the next step anyway (a 'deemed clearance') and flags the delay against that officer — so an applicant is never indefinitely stuck.
Certificate	The official document generated and issued the moment a Milestone is cleared — e.g. the Approval in Principle, a Commencement Certificate, the Occupancy Certificate — confirming that stage of the permission has been granted.
IOD (Intimation of Disapproval)	A formal disapproval document the portal can issue for a Milestone, distinct from a simple return-for-correction — used when a stage needs to be formally refused rather than merely sent back for fixing.
Final Dossier	The complete, compiled record of an Application — the original filing, every document and certificate from every Milestone along the way — automatically assembled and sent to the applicant once the Chairman gives final approval.
My Applications	The applicant's personal dashboard showing every Application they have submitted and its current Milestone/status.
Know Your Status	A lighter-weight way for an applicant to check on, correct, advance, or complain about an Application using only the Application Number and a one-time email code — without needing to log into a full account.
Account (Sign-Up) & OTP Sign-In	Applicants register once with verified personal/identity details; afterwards, signing in requires their password plus a fresh one-time code sent to their registered email each time — a two-factor check rather than a password alone.

9. The Complete Application Journey

This section walks through the entire lifecycle of one Application from the point of view of everyone who touches it, in the order events actually happen. This is the single most important section for building an accurate mental model of the product.

9.1 Before Applying — Exploring the Stream & Fee Planner (Optional)

Before ever creating an account, anyone can use the Stream & Fee Planner to pick a permission category, see its full lifecycle map and the documents each stage will require,

and get a live, non-binding fee estimate by entering a proposed built-up area and any known Concession. This lets an applicant understand the full commitment — timeline, paperwork, and likely cost — before deciding to formally apply.

9.2 Choosing a Stream

Every Application belongs to one of seven Streams, each representing a different kind of permission and carrying its own sequence of Milestones and special rules:

Stream	What It Covers	Notable Rule
New Building (Full Lifecycle)	A brand-new building, start to finish.	The structural baseline — all seven Milestones apply.
Addition / Alteration	Extending or altering an existing building.	Automatically converts to the full New Building lifecycle if the work exceeds 50% of the original built-up area.
Layout / Sub-division / Amalgamation	Subdividing or combining plots.	All internal infrastructure must be certified complete before an Occupancy Certificate is granted for more than 90% of the layout's built-up area.
Re-erection	Demolishing and rebuilding.	Blocked from starting until an MbPA inspector certifies the site is clear and vacant; adds a Demolition & Site Clearance milestone before the standard lifecycle.
Temporary Permission	Short-term structures.	Hard 3-year expiry; permanent foundations and underground works are not permitted.
Special Buildings (High-Rise / Hazardous)	Tall or higher-risk buildings.	Mandatory Fire Officer site inspection before any construction-progress certificate is issued above 70 m structural height.
Regularisation of Unauthorised Construction	Formalising existing unauthorised construction.	Automatically blocked if the plot's coordinates fall within a Coastal Regulation Zone, an operational port zone, or a heritage buffer.

9.3 Registering & Getting In

A first-time applicant registers with their name, Aadhaar number, contact details, a chosen username, and a password — the system verifies their email with a one-time code before the account is created, and rejects an attempt that reuses an Aadhaar number already on file (alerting the original account holder by email as a fraud safeguard). From then on, signing in is a two-step check: the applicant's password, followed by a fresh one-time code sent to their registered email — not a password alone, and not an OTP alone.

9.4 Filing the Application (Milestone 1 Intake)

Once signed in, the applicant starts a new Application by selecting their Stream and completing a guided, four-part intake covering: applicant & property details (including the plot's MbPA land-parcel identification), site & environmental details, design metrics & any Concessions being sought, and finally the supporting documents required for this first Milestone. The system assigns a unique Application Number the moment the application is filed.

9.5 Milestone 1 — Ingestion & Verification (→ Approval in Principle)

The filed application is first checked by the Estate Officer, then by the Junior Planner, in sequence, against the same combined time allowance. Once both clear it, the applicant receives the Approval in Principle — valid for two years — and the Application moves to the next Milestone.

9.6 Milestone 2 — Design Sanction & Foundation Clearance (→ Development Permission + Commencement Certificate to Plinth)

The applicant files this Milestone's required design and structural documents and, because this is where the Master Challan falls due, enters the payment reference for the combined scrutiny fee, refundable deposits, and any Concession Premium. The Deputy Planner reviews and clears it, issuing the five-year Development Permission and a Commencement Certificate covering construction up to plinth level.

9.7 Milestone 3 — Sub-Structure Validation (→ Further Commencement Certificate)

Once the plinth is complete, the applicant files plinth-completion documentation (including geotagged site photographs) for Deputy Planner review, who clears it for a Further Commencement Certificate covering the superstructure.

9.8 Milestones 4 & 5 — Superstructure Construction (→ 80% and Remaining 20% Built-Up-Area Commencement Certificates)

As construction proceeds, the applicant files tranche applications at the 80%-built-up-area stage (reviewed by the Junior Planner) and again for the remaining 20% (reviewed by the Deputy Planner), each releasing the next Commencement Certificate — with additional conditional clearances (environmental, aviation-height, or high-rise-committee) required automatically where the project's size or height triggers them.

9.9 Milestone 6 — Service Infrastructure Integration (→ Building Completion Certificate)

Once drainage, fire-safety, and other service systems are complete, the applicant files the relevant completion documentation for Deputy Planner review, who clears it for the Building Completion Certificate.

9.10 Milestone 7 — Statutory Finalisation (→ Occupancy Certificate)

The applicant files the Occupancy Certificate application along with proof of settled property-tax dues. The Chairman — and only the Chairman — reviews this final Milestone. Approval issues the Occupancy Certificate and, in the same moment, triggers the Final Dossier: a

complete compiled record of the entire Application across every Milestone, emailed to the applicant for their permanent records.

9.11 Throughout — Corrections, Complaints, and the SLA Safety Net

At any Milestone, if an officer returns specific documents for correction, the applicant resubmits just those documents and the file returns to scrutiny at the exact same officer who returned it. Separately, an applicant can raise a complaint against whichever officer most recently acted on their file. And independently of anything the applicant does, the system itself checks every working day whether any Application has sat with an officer beyond its prescribed time limit — if so, it automatically advances the Application anyway and flags the delay against that officer, ensuring no file is held up indefinitely (except at the very final Chairman milestone, where there is no further authority to escalate to, so the system can only keep flagging the delay while waiting for an actual decision).

10. Feature Areas & Capabilities

This section groups every capability the portal provides into logical feature areas. Each is described purely in terms of purpose and value — not how it is built.

10.1 Account Registration & Two-Factor Sign-In

Purpose: Establish a verified, fraud-resistant identity for every applicant before they can file anything, and let both applicants and officers sign in securely.

Who uses it: Applicants (registration); applicants and officers (sign-in).

What it does: Collects an applicant's name, Aadhaar number, contact details, and a chosen username/password, verifying the registration email with a one-time code. Blocks any attempt to register a second account against an Aadhaar number already on file, and alerts the existing account holder if that happens. Afterwards, signing in always requires the password followed by a fresh one-time email code — a two-factor check, not either alone.

Why it matters: Protects against duplicate or fraudulent applicant identities (an important integrity requirement for a government permission process) while still removing the friction of password-only or OTP-only access.

What “done” looks like: No applicant can hold two accounts against the same identity document, and no one can sign in to any account — applicant or officer — without both the correct password and a fresh code from the registered email.

10.2 Know Your Status (Lightweight Access)

Purpose: Let an applicant check on, correct, advance, or complain about an existing Application without needing to remember a password or stay logged in.

Who uses it: Applicants.

What it does: Using only the Application Number and a one-time code sent to the application's registered email, an applicant can view full status, resubmit corrected documents, file the next Milestone's requirements, or raise a complaint.

Why it matters: Many applicants only need occasional access to one specific file rather than an ongoing account session — this gives them a fast, secure path that doesn't depend on remembering account credentials.

What “done” looks like: An applicant can fully manage an in-progress Application using nothing but the Application Number and access to their email.

10.3 Stream & Fee Planner

Purpose: Let anyone — even before creating an account — understand what a given type of permission actually involves and roughly what it will cost.

Who uses it: Prospective applicants (and officers, for reference).

What it does: Lets a visitor pick any of the seven Streams, see its full Milestone-by-Milestone lifecycle map and required documents at each stage, and enter a proposed built-up area, a Concession (if any), and the applicable land rate to get a live, non-binding fee estimate.

Why it matters: Removes guesswork and surprise before someone commits time and money to a formal application — a direct EoDB transparency win.

What “done” looks like: Anyone can answer 'what would this actually involve and roughly cost?' for any permission type, without registering or filing anything.

10.4 New Application Filing (Guided Intake)

Purpose: Let an applicant start a new Application by capturing everything the first Milestone requires, in a structured, step-by-step way.

Who uses it: Applicants.

What it does: A four-part guided form — applicant & property details, site & environmental details, design metrics & Concessions, and supporting documents — ending in an automatically assigned, unique Application Number.

Why it matters: This is the entry point into the entire system; capturing complete, well-structured information here is what makes every downstream Milestone and review possible.

What “done” looks like: Every new Application is created with a complete first-Milestone record and a unique Application Number, with no duplicates even under simultaneous filings.

10.5 Automated Compliance & Fee Calculation

Purpose: Give the applicant (and the system itself) an instant, accurate, and consistent read on how a project's figures compare to UPDR-2026 standards, and what any departure will cost.

Who uses it: Applicants (built into both the Planner and the actual filing); indirectly, officers (consistent baseline figures to review).

What it does: As design metrics and any Concessions are entered, automatically computes the scrutiny fee, refundable deposits, and any Concession Premium using UPDR-2026's fixed coefficients and the land rate supplied.

Why it matters: Removes regulatory and arithmetic ambiguity from the process — the same project gets the same answer no matter who is applying or which officer eventually reviews it.

What “done” looks like: An applicant never discovers a hidden cost only after the fact — the full fee picture for the current Milestone is visible before they file it.

10.6 My Applications Dashboard & Milestone Tracking

Purpose: Give applicants self-service visibility into exactly where each of their Applications stands in its lifecycle.

Who uses it: Applicants.

What it does: A personal list of every Application the applicant has filed, each showing its current Milestone out of the total for its Stream, the officer/role currently responsible, any rejection reasons, certificates issued so far, and payment status.

Why it matters: Directly answers the applicant's most common question — 'where is my file, and what happens next?' — without involving an officer's time at all.

What “done” looks like: An applicant can always see precisely which Milestone they are on, what is expected of them next, and what has already been granted.

10.7 Officer Review Console (Milestone-Based Scrutiny)

Purpose: Give each reviewing officer a queue of exactly the applications relevant to their role, and a structured way to clear or return them.

Who uses it: Estate Officer, Junior Planner, Deputy Planner, Chairman — each sees only applications currently sitting at a Milestone their role is responsible for.

What it does: An inbox of applications 'to verify', plus separate views of ones already verified, ones returned for correction, and two distinct complaint queues (see 10.11). Reviewing an application lets the officer clear it forward, or return specific documents with a written reason.

Why it matters: Replaces ad-hoc manual cross-checking with a consistent, structured, fully recorded review — nothing gets missed, and every decision has a documented reason attached to the exact document it concerns.

What “done” looks like: Every officer's queue only ever shows work that is actually theirs, and every decision (clear or return) is recorded against the specific application, Milestone, and document.

10.8 Multi-Milestone Approval Chain

Purpose: Ensure every Application passes through the correct officer(s), in the correct order, at every one of its Stream's Milestones — mirroring MbPA's real internal accountability structure.

Who uses it: All four officer roles, as assigned per Milestone (see Section 17 for the full mapping).

What it does: Moves an Application strictly forward through each Milestone's assigned role(s) — e.g. Estate Officer then Junior Planner for the first Milestone, the Deputy Planner alone for several others, the Chairman alone for the last — with no Milestone or step skippable.

Why it matters: This is what gives the final Occupancy Certificate real institutional weight — it is never a blind sign-off, because every earlier Milestone has already been cleared by the officer(s) statutorily responsible for it.

What “done” looks like: No Application ever reaches final approval without having passed, in order, through every Milestone and every officer role its Stream requires.

10.9 SLA Tracking & Automatic Deemed Clearance

Purpose: Guarantee that an Application can never be held up indefinitely by an unresponsive officer, while still holding that officer accountable for the delay.

Who uses it: Runs automatically in the background; its effects are visible to applicants (faster progress) and officers (a flag against their name).

What it does: Every Milestone carries a prescribed number of working days. A daily automatic check finds any Application that has exceeded its allowed time at the current officer, advances it to the next step or Milestone anyway (treating it as cleared), and records a flag against the officer who missed the deadline. At the very final (Chairman) Milestone, since there is no further authority to escalate to, the system can only keep flagging the delay while waiting for an actual decision.

Why it matters: This is a direct, built-in version of the 'deemed approval' principle common to Ease of Doing Business reforms — if government doesn't act in time, the citizen is not the one who pays the price.

What “done” looks like: No Application can be silently stuck forever; every prolonged delay is both resolved (where possible) and visibly attributed to the responsible officer.

10.10 Progressive, Milestone-Tied Payments

Purpose: Charge the applicant the right amount, at the right point in the lifecycle, for the right reason — rather than a single lump sum upfront.

Who uses it: Applicants (to pay and see status); the Planning Department (to see what has been collected).

What it does: The combined scrutiny fee, refundable deposits, and any Concession Premium fall due together at the Development Permission Milestone. Later Milestones carry their own separately-assessed charges — infrastructure/utility connection charges at the sub-structure stage, and any outstanding property-tax settlement before the Occupancy Certificate — each handled by recording a payment reference at the relevant point.

Why it matters: Mirrors how real construction projects actually incur cost over time, and keeps each charge clearly tied to the regulatory event that triggers it rather than bundling everything into one confusing figure.

What “done” looks like: At any point, anyone looking at an Application can see exactly what has fallen due so far, for which Milestone, and whether it has been settled.

10.11 Complaint System (Applicant-Raised & System-Raised)

Purpose: Surface accountability problems — whether reported by the applicant or detected automatically — directly to the relevant officer's queue.

Who uses it: Applicants (can raise a complaint); officers (see complaints raised against their handling, of both kinds).

What it does: Two distinct complaint types reach an officer's console: complaints the system itself raises automatically when that officer breaches the SLA, and complaints an applicant deliberately raises against whichever officer most recently acted on their file, via a short checklist and free-text explanation.

Why it matters: Keeps both kinds of accountability — systemic delay and a citizen's direct grievance — visible and actionable, rather than disappearing into an inbox.

What “done” looks like: Every delay flagged by the system, and every complaint raised by an applicant, lands in a clearly separated, trackable queue for the relevant officer and department.

10.12 Certificate & Disapproval Issuance, Final Dossier Compilation

Purpose: Produce the correct official output the moment each Milestone is decided, and compile the complete record once the whole lifecycle concludes.

Who uses it: Triggered by officer/Chairman decisions; received by the applicant.

What it does: Issues the relevant certificate (Approval in Principle, Development Permission, Commencement Certificates, Building Completion Certificate, Occupancy Certificate) the moment each Milestone clears, or a formal Intimation of Disapproval where a Milestone is refused outright. On final Chairman approval, automatically compiles every document and certificate from every Milestone into one Final Dossier and emails it to the applicant.

Why it matters: Removes manual drafting (and its associated delay and inconsistency) from the most important documents in the entire process, and guarantees the applicant ends up with one complete, permanent record rather than a scattered set of separate emails.

What “done” looks like: Every cleared Milestone produces its correct certificate automatically, and every fully-approved Application ends with one complete, consolidated dossier.

10.13 Prescribed Document Formats Download

Purpose: Let an applicant obtain the exact paper formats UPDR-2026 prescribes, so they can be filled out (often by a third party, like a structural engineer) before being uploaded.

Who uses it: Applicants.

What it does: A single downloadable PDF bundling the prescribed document formats relevant to the permission process.

Why it matters: Many required documents (certificates, undertakings, registers) follow a fixed regulatory format that must be completed exactly as prescribed — this guarantees the applicant is working from the correct, current version.

What “done” looks like: An applicant always has access to the correct, current version of every prescribed paper format they need to complete and upload.

11. Business Rules & Policy Logic (Conceptual)

These are not implementation details — they are regulatory and institutional policies the product exists to enforce correctly and consistently. Anyone working on this product, technical or not, must treat them as fixed facts rather than configurable preferences, unless MbPA itself revises the underlying regulation.

11.1 Single Source of Regulatory Truth

Every substantive rule the portal applies — what each Milestone requires, what counts as a Concession, what Premium applies — must come exclusively from UPDR-2026. Older municipal frameworks (such as MCGM's DCR 1991 or DCPR-2034) may have influenced the structure or layout of certain forms, but they must never function as a live regulatory authority anywhere in the portal's actual decisions or outputs. No value in the system should ever be invented or assumed — every figure must be traceable to UPDR-2026, and where no sourced formula exists (for example, infrastructure/utility charges or property-tax arrears), the portal says so explicitly rather than guessing a number.

11.2 Fee & Premium Policy

UPDR-2026 prescribes a standard per-area fee structure, charged on the proposed built-up area (BUA), plus fixed premium coefficients for specific categories of Concession:

Charge	Basis
Scrutiny fee	₹50 per m ² of proposed built-up area
Security deposit (refundable)	₹10 per m ² of proposed built-up area
Debris-disposal deposit (refundable)	₹20 per m ² of proposed built-up area

Concession Category	Premium Coefficient	Premium Formula
Additional floor space beyond standard entitlement	110%	Extra area sought × Zonal RRR × 1.10
Open space shortfall	25%	Shortfall area × Zonal RRR × 0.25
Parking / component waiver	40%	Waived area × Zonal RRR × 0.40

These coefficients are policy facts, not adjustable settings — they change only if UPDR-2026 itself is amended by MbPA. The scrutiny fee, both deposits, and any Premium are combined into a single Master Challan, due at the Development Permission Milestone, before technical scrutiny of that Milestone begins. The Zonal RRR (the official land rate for the relevant port zone) is never pre-filled by the system — it must always be sourced from MbPA's actual Ready Reckoner and entered by whoever is filing or estimating.

11.3 Strict Milestone & Officer Sequencing

An Application must pass through every Milestone of its Stream in order, and within a Milestone, through every officer role assigned to it in order. No Milestone or officer step may

be skipped, and no later step can be reached before every earlier one has been cleared (either by genuine approval or by an SLA-driven deemed clearance). This is what gives the final Occupancy Certificate its institutional integrity.

11.4 MbPA-Specific Terminology, Not Municipal Terminology

The portal deliberately uses MbPA's own terminology rather than the equivalent municipal terms an outside developer might expect, because the two are legally distinct contexts. For example:

Municipal (MCGM/BMC) Term	MbPA / UPDR-2026 Equivalent Used in the Portal
CTS / CS No. (plot identification number)	PLPN (Port Land Parcel Number) — captured at the very first step of every application
Development Plan	PMP
R.L. of street (Reduced Level)	PRL
DCR (Development Control Regulations)	UPDR

A developer should never assume these terms are interchangeable with their municipal counterparts — they represent distinct fields and distinct legal authority.

11.5 Milestone-Specific Document Checklists, Drawn from UPDR-2026's Prescribed Forms

Each Milestone carries its own fixed checklist of required documents, drawn directly from UPDR-2026's named Forms and Annexures rather than any generic list — for example, the Development Permission Milestone specifically requires the Project Fact Sheet (Form 4A) and the Design Scrutiny Register (Form 4B) among its documents; the sub-structure Milestone requires the Intimation of Plinth Completion (Annexure-10); and the final Milestone requires the Occupancy Certificate application itself (Annexure-14). These are genuine, named regulatory documents the applicant must obtain or have certified and upload — not screens the portal invents internally — and the exact list differs from one Milestone to the next.

12. Success Criteria — What “Working Well” Looks Like

From This Perspective...	Success Looks Like
The Applicant	Can register once, explore costs before filing, submit at each Milestone, immediately understand any Concessions and their cost, track progress through the full lifecycle without visiting the office, raise a complaint if stuck, and receive each certificate — and a final dossier — the moment it is due.
The Estate Officer / Junior Planner / Deputy Planner	Only ever sees applications genuinely at a Milestone their role owns, has a clear screen to review documents and decide, and can return specific items for correction with a clear, recorded reason.

From This Perspective...	Success Looks Like
The Chairman	Only ever sees applications that have already cleared every earlier statutory Milestone, making the final Occupancy Certificate decision fast and low-risk.
MbPA as an Institution	Every granted permission is backed by a consistent, auditable trail across its full lifecycle; no file can be silently stuck on an unresponsive officer; approval timelines shrink; the Planning Department visibly delivers on its EoDB mandate.
A Future Developer/Maintainer	Can read this PRD and correctly explain the entire product's purpose, lifecycle, and behaviour before opening a single line of code.

13. Assumptions & Dependencies

- Every applicant has a working, individually-owned email address and a valid Aadhaar number — both are required at registration, and identity is checked at every sign-in via password plus a fresh one-time email code.
- Officer accounts (Estate Officer, Junior Planner, Deputy Planner, Chairman) are set up in advance by an internal administrator with their own username and password; there is no public self-registration path for officer roles.
- UPDR-2026 is treated as final and authoritative for all current regulatory logic in the system; any future amendment to UPDR-2026 would require corresponding updates to the portal's rules, fee coefficients, and document checklists.
- The Zonal Ready Reckoner Rate is not stored anywhere in the system — it is assumed that whoever is filing or estimating a fee will look up and correctly enter MbPA's current official rate for that zone each time.
- The automatic SLA check that promotes overdue Applications runs once per day rather than instantly — a breach is detected and acted on within roughly a day of the deadline passing, not the same minute.
- The portal assumes a reasonably reliable internet connection for both applicants and officers — it is a connected, real-time system rather than an offline-first tool.
- Applicants are assumed to have basic digital literacy (using a browser, checking email for a one-time code, assembling and uploading scanned documents) — no in-person digital literacy support is currently part of the product's scope.

14. Risks & Open Questions

Topic	Open Question / Risk	Why It Matters
Zonal RRR accuracy	The official land rate for fee calculation is never stored in the system — it relies entirely on whoever is filing or estimating to enter the correct, current figure.	An incorrect rate would miscalculate the Premium with no system-side check against MbPA's actual records; this should be paired with clear guidance (or, eventually, an official rate table) for whoever

Topic	Open Question / Risk	Why It Matters
		enters it.
Officer awareness of deemed clearance	The automatic SLA-driven promotion is a deliberate feature, but if officers are not clearly briefed on it, a missed deadline silently advancing 'their' file might be misread as a system fault rather than the intended accountability mechanism.	Getting this wrong could cause confusion or mistrust in the tool among the very officers who are meant to benefit from a fairer, faster process.
Email notification volume at scale	The underlying email-sending mechanism has a daily sending cap that has not been a constraint yet, but could become one as the number of applicants and Milestone notifications grows.	If application volume grows significantly, a more scalable notification approach may eventually be needed — this should be monitored, not assumed solved.
Aadhaar as the sole uniqueness anchor	Each applicant account is permanently tied to one Aadhaar number, with no system-side path to update or recover this if an applicant's circumstances change (e.g. a genuine data-entry error at registration).	A process for legitimate corrections/exceptions should exist outside the portal itself, since the system intentionally has no self-service way to alter this once set.

15. Future Roadmap (Beyond Current Scope)

The core lifecycle, fee engine, officer console, SLA accountability mechanism, complaint handling, and certificate/dossier generation described in this PRD are complete in the current build. The items below are forward-looking refinements, not missing core capability.

1. Populate an official, MbPA-maintained Zonal Ready Reckoner Rate reference (today this must be sourced and entered manually each time — see Section 14).
2. Brief officers clearly on the automatic SLA-driven deemed-clearance mechanism so a missed deadline is understood as the intended accountability feature it is, not a system fault.
3. Revisit notification delivery to ensure it scales smoothly as application volume grows (see Section 14).
4. Define an out-of-portal process for the rare case where an applicant's registration details (e.g. Aadhaar) were entered incorrectly and need correction.

16. Glossary of Terms

Term	Meaning
MbPA	Mumbai Port Authority — the institution operating this portal.
SPA	Special Planning Authority — MbPA's legal status, allowing it to grant building permissions on its own land independently of the city municipal

Term	Meaning
	authority.
UPDR-2026	Unified Port Development Regulations, 2026 — MbPA's own regulatory document; the sole source of truth for all rules the portal enforces.
EoDB	Ease of Doing Business — the broader government initiative this portal is built to support, by making regulatory processes faster and more transparent.
BUA	Built-Up Area — the actual constructed floor area of a project; the basis for most fee calculations.
FSI	Floor Space Index — the ratio of permitted built-up area to plot area; a key regulated parameter, and the most common Concession category.
PLPN	Port Land Parcel Number — MbPA's plot identification number (the equivalent of a municipal CTS/CS Number); captured at the very start of every application.
PMP	MbPA's own master/development plan (the equivalent of a municipal Development Plan).
PRL	Plot Road Level (the equivalent of a municipal 'R.L. of street').
AIP	Approval in Principle — the certificate issued when the first lifecycle Milestone is cleared; valid for two years.
Stream	The category of permission an applicant is seeking (e.g. New Building, Addition/Alteration, Temporary Permission); determines which Milestones apply.
Milestone	One statutory stage of the building-permission lifecycle, each with its own required documents, responsible officer(s), and regulatory output.
Concession	A specific way a project departs from standard entitlement (e.g. extra floor space, reduced open space, a parking waiver), requiring a Premium to be permitted.
Premium	The additional charge prescribed by UPDR-2026 to permit a specific Concession, calculated from the extra area, the official zonal land rate, and a fixed coefficient.
Master Challan	The single combined payment (scrutiny fee, refundable deposits, and any Premium) due at the Development Permission Milestone.
Zonal RRR	Zonal Ready Reckoner Rate — the official government land valuation rate for a port zone, manually sourced and entered for fee calculations.
Document Slot	A specific document UPDR-2026 requires for a given Milestone; each Milestone has its own fixed checklist.
SLA / Deemed Clearance	The automatic mechanism that advances an Application past an officer who has not acted within the prescribed time, while flagging the delay against that officer.
IOD	Intimation of Disapproval — a formal document issued when a Milestone is refused outright, as distinct from a simple return-for-correction.
Final Dossier	The complete, compiled record of an Application across every Milestone,

Term	Meaning
	assembled and emailed to the applicant on final Chairman approval.
Estate Officer / JP / DP	Estate Officer, Junior Planner, and Deputy Planner — three of the four officer roles responsible for specific Milestones, preceding the Chairman's final sign-off.
OTP	One-Time Password — the short-lived email code required, alongside a password, to sign in; also used alone for the lighter-weight 'Know your status' access.
Certificate	The official document confirming a given Milestone (e.g. AIP, Development Permission, Occupancy Certificate) has been granted.

17. Appendix — Milestone & Stream Reference

17.1 The Seven Milestones — Statutory Output & Responsible Officer(s)

This is the baseline lifecycle used by the New Building Stream; other Streams use a subset of these Milestones (see 17.2). Within a Milestone, officers listed act in the order shown.

Milestone	Statutory Output	Responsible Officer(s), In Order	Working Days Allowed
S1 — Ingestion & Verification	Approval in Principle (valid 2 years)	Estate Officer, then Junior Planner	21 (combined)
S2 — Design Sanction & Foundation Clearance	Development Permission (valid 5 years) + Commencement Certificate to plinth	Deputy Planner	30
S3 — Sub-Structure Validation	Further Commencement Certificate (superstructure)	Deputy Planner	7
S4 — Superstructure, 80% BUA	80% Built-Up-Area Commencement Certificate	Junior Planner	7
S5 — Superstructure, Remaining 20% BUA	Remaining 20% Built-Up-Area Commencement Certificate	Deputy Planner	15
S6 — Service Infrastructure Integration	Building Completion Certificate	Deputy Planner	7
S7 — Statutory Finalisation (final)	Occupancy Certificate	Chairman	15

Re-erection Stream only — a Demolition & Site Clearance step precedes S1, handled by the Estate Officer (10 working days). Note: this particular step and time allowance is not directly sourced from a specific UPDR-2026 table; it is a working assumption pending formal confirmation, kept deliberately separate from the sourced figures above.

17.2 The Seven Streams — Which Milestones Each Includes

Stream	Milestones Included	Stage Count
New Building (Full Lifecycle)	S1 → S2 → S3 → S4 → S5 → S6 → S7	7
Addition / Alteration	S1 → S2 → S3 → S6 → S7	5
Layout / Sub-division / Amalgamation	S1 → S2 → S3 → S6 → S7	5
Re-erection	DEMO → S1 → S2 → S3 → S4 → S5 → S6 → S7	8
Temporary Permission	S1 → S2 → S6 → S7	4
Special Buildings (High-Rise / Hazardous)	S1 → S2 → S3 → S4 → S5 → S6 → S7	7
Regularisation of Unauthorised Construction	S1 → S2 → S3 → S4 → S6 → S7	6